

Crypto Perpetual Futures Alpha Hypothesis Catalogue

How to read this catalogue

Perpetual futures dominate crypto derivatives activity, and they are not just “levered spot.” Their funding mechanics, mark-price logic, liquidation rules, and venue-specific risk controls change both price formation and trade survivability. Academic and exchange research now points to several repeatable ingredients that matter for alpha generation: crypto time-series momentum and short-horizon continuation; longer-horizon reversal; cross-cryptocurrency return predictability; funding-cycle effects; intraday seasonal patterns tied to Asia, Europe, and U.S. activity; and liquidation-driven dislocations that are amplified by mark-price and oracle design. ¹

A no-vendor workflow is realistic, but venue choice matters. Kraken publicly exposes futures tickers with mark price and current open interest, historical funding rates, and chart candles; its EEA perpetuals settle funding hourly. Bybit publicly exposes kline, mark-price kline, funding-history, open-interest, insurance-pool, and full liquidation-stream endpoints. Binance publicly exposes funding-rate history, mark-price data, open-interest statistics, insurance-fund snapshots, and symbol-level ADL risk. In practice, that means many bar-, mark-, funding-, OI-, and announcement-based ideas are testable immediately, while some liquidation- and deep microstructure-driven ideas need forward live capture if tested on Kraken alone. ²

I use a simple internal data taxonomy throughout the catalogue. **Tier 1** means bars, mark, funding, OI, and official announcements. **Tier 2** means forward capture of top-book, liquidation streams, funding estimates, and venue spreads. **Tier 3** means tick-level or deep-order-book replay. Many of the best small-account hypotheses live in Tier 1 or in Tier 1 plus a light Tier 2 capture layer. Strategies that need Tier 3 are included because the mechanism can still be sound even if Kraken-first testing is weak. ³

Trend and breakout hypotheses

H01 — Liquid leader continuation

hypothesis_id: H01; **short_name:** Liquid leader continuation. **alpha_mechanism:** continuation in the most liquid perp leaders after a high-volume directional break. **why_it_might_work:** crypto shows time-series momentum and intraday continuation, while liquid leaders tend to incorporate information first and attract follow-through order flow. ⁴

best_context_or_regime: strong market trend; high leader-relative strength; positive breadth.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: choppy range; widening spreads; macro event hour.

universe: BTC, ETH, SOL, major liquid alts. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 4h-5d.

entry_rule_sketch: buy or short 4h breakout with same-direction daily trend and top-decile relative volume. **exit_rule_sketch:** trail below prior 4h swing or 2-3 ATR. **risk_stop_logic:** hard stop below breakout bar low or above breakout short high.

required_data: OHLCV, mark price. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public 15m/1h OHLCV plus

mark. `ideal_data`: mark/index bars plus venue spread and taker flow. `data_tier`: Tier 1.
`Kraken_feasibility`: high. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high.
`live_capture_substitute_needed`: no.
`main_failure_mode`: false breakouts during mean-reverting ranges. `how_to_falsify`: show no edge after fees outside top-volume names or when daily trend filter is removed.
`suggested_null_or_control`: same breakout rule on random liquid names without RS ranking.
`overfit_risk`: medium. `priority`: high. `freshness_or_novelty`: common.
`sources_supporting`: crypto TSMOM and intraday momentum evidence. ⁴
`sources_against_or_cautions`: momentum crashes and regime dependence. ⁵

H02 — Volatility-managed time-series momentum

`hypothesis_id`: H02; `short_name`: Vol-managed TSMOM. `alpha_mechanism`: classic trend signal with exposure scaled down when realized vol spikes. `why_it_might_work`: crypto momentum exists, but unscaled momentum suffers severe crash risk; volatility management improved momentum portfolios in recent crypto research. ⁶
`best_context_or_regime`: persistent trends in BTC, ETH, top majors.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition`: post-crash snapback; volatility explosion after exhaustion.
`universe`: BTC, ETH, SOL, XRP, top 10–20 perps. `direction`: both. `holding_period`: 1d–4w.
`entry_rule_sketch`: sign of 20–120d trend or 24h/72h hybrid, position size proportional to target vol.
`exit_rule_sketch`: signal flip or volatility cap breach. `risk_stop_logic`: portfolio-level vol cap, instrument max loss, kill-switch after abnormal gap.
`required_data`: daily or 4h OHLCV, mark. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data`: public OHLCV.
`ideal_data`: mark/index, funding carry, OI. `data_tier`: Tier 1. `Kraken_feasibility`: high.
`Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high. `live_capture_substitute_needed`: no.
`main_failure_mode`: under-allocation during best trends or whipsaws in mean reversion.
`how_to_falsify`: no improvement in Sharpe/max drawdown versus unscaled TSMOM out of sample.
`suggested_null_or_control`: equal-risk unscaled momentum. `overfit_risk`: low-medium.
`priority`: high. `freshness_or_novelty`: underused. `sources_supporting`: TSMOM and vol-managed momentum literature. ⁶ `sources_against_or_cautions`: crypto momentum tails are unstable and crash-prone. ⁷

H03 — All-time-high proximity continuation

`hypothesis_id`: H03; `short_name`: ATH proximity continuation. `alpha_mechanism`: assets near prior ATH break more cleanly than “mid-range” assets because underwater supply is thinner and attention is concentrated. `why_it_might_work`: the 52-week-high effect is robust in equities and appears related to underreaction near salient reference points; crypto has stronger reflexive attention around ATH zones, making the translation worth testing. ⁸
`best_context_or_regime`: leaders within 5–10% of ATH with improving breadth.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition`: broad market distribution; failed BTC trend. `universe`: majors and liquid alts. `direction`: long. `holding_period`: 1d–3w. `entry_rule_sketch`: enter on daily close above prior 30d high when distance to ATH is small and BTC regime is risk-on.
`exit_rule_sketch`: close below breakout range low or loss of relative strength. `risk_stop_logic`: 1.5–2 ATR or failed retest.
`required_data`: daily OHLCV, ATH history. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data`: public OHLCV.
`ideal_data`: mark, funding, OI, breadth. `data_tier`: Tier 1. `Kraken_feasibility`: high.
`Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high. `live_capture_substitute_needed`: no.

main_failure_mode: repeated resistance touches before breakdown. **how_to_falsify:** compare returns of near-ATH breakouts versus identical breakouts far from ATH. **suggested_null_or_control:** breakout rule without ATH-distance filter. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** medium-high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** 52-week-high literature and reference-point mechanism. ⁸ **sources_against_or_cautions:** direct crypto-specific ATH evidence is weaker than in equities. ⁹

H04 — Prior-major-high reclaim continuation

hypothesis_id: H04; **short_name:** Prior-high reclaim. **alpha_mechanism:** reclaim of a major swing high after a long base triggers under-owned trend continuation. **why_it_might_work:** short-horizon momentum exists in crypto, and markets near well-watched highs often re-rate once overhead supply is cleared. ¹⁰

best_context_or_regime: multiweek base; BTC/ETH trend aligned.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: low breadth; adverse macro day. **universe:** liquid alts and majors. **direction:** long. **holding_period:** 2d-4w. **entry_rule_sketch:** enter on reclaim of prior cycle/swing high with volume expansion. **exit_rule_sketch:** time stop after 10 bars without extension or close back inside base. **risk_stop_logic:** below reclaimed level or base midpoint.

required_data: daily/4h OHLCV. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public OHLCV. **ideal_data:** mark, funding, OI, sector breadth. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.

main_failure_mode: breakout into supply from trapped longs. **how_to_falsify:** no alpha versus generic 20d breakout once base length is controlled. **suggested_null_or_control:** simple 20d breakout on same assets. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** medium. **freshness_or_novelty:** common. **sources_supporting:** momentum plus reference-point evidence. ¹¹

sources_against_or_cautions: long-horizon reversal can dominate if the move is already extended. ¹²

H05 — Post-breakout retest hold

hypothesis_id: H05; **short_name:** Breakout retest. **alpha_mechanism:** continuation after first controlled retest of a fresh breakout level. **why_it_might_work:** breakout-follow-through works better when the market proves the prior resistance has flipped to support; this echoes practitioner breakout logic and reduces chase risk. ¹³

best_context_or_regime: strong trend, moderate vol, improving breadth.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: immediate loss of breakout level on high volume.

universe: top-volume perps; selected theme leaders. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 6h-10d.

entry_rule_sketch: wait for breakout, then enter on retest that holds above level on shrinking range.

exit_rule_sketch: exit if retest fails or after momentum thrust target. **risk_stop_logic:** just through retest low/high.

required_data: OHLCV. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public 15m-4h OHLCV. **ideal_data:** mark, volume profile, funding/OI. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.

main_failure_mode: fake level flip in broad chop. **how_to_falsify:** no better expectancy than breakout-at-close entries once slippage is counted. **suggested_null_or_control:** buy breakout close without retest requirement. **overfit_risk:** low-medium. **priority:** high.

freshness_or_novelty: common. **sources_supporting:** breakout and pullback continuation logic. ¹³ **sources_against_or_cautions:** false breakouts remain common in non-trending markets. ¹⁴

H06 — Volatility contraction breakout

hypothesis_id: H06; **short_name:** Crypto VCP. **alpha_mechanism:** volatility and range contract through several pullbacks, then expand in the trend direction. **why_it_might_work:** contraction structures reflect supply exhaustion in trend markets; crypto's episodic impulsive trends make these setups plausible, especially in liquid names where volume information is cleaner. ¹⁵

best_context_or_regime: strong uptrend, rising moving averages, tight daily ranges.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: contracting range caused by dead liquidity rather than absorption. **universe:** major and upper-mid-cap perps. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 1d-3w. **entry_rule_sketch:** enter on breakout from final tight contraction. **exit_rule_sketch:** swing low trail or 2R/3R partials. **risk_stop_logic:** below final contraction low.

required_data: OHLCV. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** daily/4h OHLCV. **ideal_data:** mark, volume profile, OI. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** medium-high.

Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.

main_failure_mode: low-float manipulation masquerading as contraction. **how_to_falsify:** no edge after excluding illiquid names and requiring prior trend. **suggested_null_or_control:** breakout from random equal-width ranges. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** medium.

freshness_or_novelty: underused. **sources_supporting:** VCP and breakout practitioner literature. ¹⁵ **sources_against_or_cautions:** crypto small caps can compress because participation vanishes, not because supply is exhausted. ¹⁶

H07 — Leader base in sector leader, not laggard

hypothesis_id: H07; **short_name:** Leader-base continuation. **alpha_mechanism:** only trade base breakouts in the relative-strength leader of a sector/theme basket. **why_it_might_work:** cross-crypto predictability and industry-information effects imply that leadership structure matters; the strongest coin in a theme often pulls the rest. ¹⁷

best_context_or_regime: early/mid theme rotation. **worst_context_or_disable_condition:** late-stage crowded theme with weakening leader breadth. **universe:** sector baskets such as L2, DeFi, AI, memecoin leaders. **direction:** long. **holding_period:** 1d-2w. **entry_rule_sketch:** rank sector by RS vs BTC/ETH; trade only top-ranked name on base breakout. **exit_rule_sketch:** RS roll-over or base failure. **risk_stop_logic:** below base low and sector breadth stop.

required_data: OHLCV across basket. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public OHLCV for basket members. **ideal_data:** mark, OI, funding, breadth metrics. **data_tier:** Tier 1.

Kraken_feasibility: low-medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.

live_capture_substitute_needed: no.

main_failure_mode: wrong sector classification; theme dispersion too low. **how_to_falsify:** no difference between leader and randomly chosen sector member. **suggested_null_or_control:** equal-probability breakout selection within theme. **overfit_risk:** medium-high. **priority:** medium.

freshness_or_novelty: underused. **sources_supporting:** cross-crypto lead-lag and industry information effects. ¹⁸ **sources_against_or_cautions:** narrative sector definitions are unstable and can drift quickly. ¹⁹

H08 — Failed breakdown squeeze reclaim

hypothesis_id: H08; **short_name:** Breakdown failure reclaim. **alpha_mechanism:** short-side trap after a breakdown fails and price reclaims range support. **why_it_might_work:** crypto intraday reversal and liquidity shocks can produce abrupt squeezes after false downside resolution, especially after liquidation-heavy drops. ²⁰

best_context_or_regime: sharp downside probe into support with rapid reclaim.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: true regime change after macro shock. **universe:** majors and liquid alts. **direction:** long. **holding_period:** hours-5d. **entry_rule_sketch:** enter on close back inside prior range after breakdown and reclaim of mark VWAP. **exit_rule_sketch:** prior range high or failure back below reclaim. **risk_stop_logic:** below reclaim low.
required_data: OHLCV, mark. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** 5m-1h bars plus mark.
ideal_data: liquidation stream, OI delta. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** medium-high. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** optional.
main_failure_mode: catching a pause within a true downtrend. **how_to_falsify:** returns disappear when exogenous crash days are excluded or when no reclaim close is required.
suggested_null_or_control: buy any 2-sigma down day next bar. **overfit_risk:** medium.
priority: medium-high. **freshness_or_novelty:** common. **sources_supporting:** intraday predictability and liquidation-cascade mechanics. ²⁰ **sources_against_or_cautions:** reversal can fail badly during deleveraging continuations. ²¹

H09 — Strong close trend-day continuation

hypothesis_id: H09; **short_name:** Trend-day to next-session drift. **alpha_mechanism:** close-in-top-decile days with volume expansion continue into the next active session. **why_it_might_work:** crypto intraday continuation and session clustering suggest information does not finish diffusing within a single clock segment. ²²
best_context_or_regime: trend days into active handoff between regions.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: funding settlement immediately ahead; macro data within hours. **universe:** BTC, ETH, liquid alts. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 2h-2d.
entry_rule_sketch: long or short after a wide-range close near extreme with above-average volume.
exit_rule_sketch: next-session ORB failure or gap fill. **risk_stop_logic:** intraday midpoint loss.
required_data: intraday OHLCV. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** 5m/15m bars. **ideal_data:** session-labeled volume and mark. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high.
Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.
main_failure_mode: exhaustion move mistaken for initiation. **how_to_falsify:** no difference between strong-close days and average close-location days. **suggested_null_or_control:** same range day without close-location filter. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** medium.
freshness_or_novelty: underused. **sources_supporting:** intraday continuation and seasonality.
²² **sources_against_or_cautions:** trend edges can flip around major policy and macro announcements. ²³

H10 — Relative-strength breakout versus BTC

hypothesis_id: H10; **short_name:** RS breakout vs BTC. **alpha_mechanism:** go long alts that break out in their USD perp and in their ALT/BTC relative series. **why_it_might_work:** cross-crypto return predictability and leader-laggard spillovers imply that relative strength contains information beyond absolute trend. ²⁴
best_context_or_regime: alt rotation days; BTC stable or grinding up.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: BTC impulse selloff. **universe:** liquid alt perps.
direction: long. **holding_period:** 1d-2w. **entry_rule_sketch:** require breakout in USD and RS line above 20-60d high. **exit_rule_sketch:** RS line fails first or USD structure breaks.
risk_stop_logic: lowest of price stop and RS stop.

required_data: OHLCV for coin and BTC. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public OHLCV.
 ideal_data: cross-venue OI/funding for coin and BTC. data_tier: Tier 1. Kraken_feasibility: medium. Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high.
 live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
 main_failure_mode: RS signal is just beta to sector froth. how_to_falsify: no incremental edge after conditioning on coin's own breakout. suggested_null_or_control: coin breakout without RS filter. overfit_risk: medium. priority: medium-high. freshness_or_novelty: underused.
 sources_supporting: cross-crypto predictability and BTC/ETH leadership papers. ²⁴
 sources_against_or_cautions: correlations spike in stress and crush idiosyncratic RS edges. ²⁵

H11 — Breakout before funding confirmation

hypothesis_id: H11; short_name: Early breakout before funding catch-up. alpha_mechanism: enter when price breaks out but funding is still near neutral, avoiding already-crowded moves.
 why_it_might_work: funding is a lagging reflection of positioning; trend may start before crowding becomes obvious. Funding-cycle and market-quality work implies positioning adjustments cluster through the cycle rather than instantly. ²⁶
 best_context_or_regime: clean breakout from low volatility; spot-led move.
 worst_context_or_disable_condition: funding already extreme or OI spike already crowded.
 universe: liquid perps. direction: both. holding_period: 6h-7d. entry_rule_sketch: breakout with funding percentile below 60 and improving range expansion. exit_rule_sketch: take partial when funding jumps into top decile. risk_stop_logic: standard breakout stop.
 required_data: OHLCV, funding. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public bars plus funding history.
 ideal_data: mark, OI, basis. data_tier: Tier 1. Kraken_feasibility: medium-high.
 Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
 main_failure_mode: funding stays low because breakout is false. how_to_falsify: no improvement over breakout strategy without funding filter. suggested_null_or_control: same breakout without funding condition. overfit_risk: medium. priority: medium-high.
 freshness_or_novelty: underused. sources_supporting: funding as positioning signal, but not sufficient alone. ²⁷ sources_against_or_cautions: funding often lags, and interpretation without OI/context is error-prone. ²⁸

H12 — Compression to expansion breakout

hypothesis_id: H12; short_name: Vol-compression expansion. alpha_mechanism: trade expansion out of realized-volatile lows. why_it_might_work: crypto exhibits periodic intraday and cross-cycle volatility clustering; low realized volatility often precedes directional resolution. ²⁹
 best_context_or_regime: multi-day RV in bottom decile.
 worst_context_or_disable_condition: event blackout or dead-liquidity microcaps. universe: majors and selected liquid alts. direction: both. holding_period: hours-1w.
 entry_rule_sketch: enter on break of compression range after N-bar RV percentile filter.
 exit_rule_sketch: stop-and-reverse on opposite breakout or ATR trail. risk_stop_logic: opposite side of squeeze box.
 required_data: OHLCV. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public intraday bars. ideal_data: mark, spread, OI. data_tier: Tier 1. Kraken_feasibility: high.
 Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
 main_failure_mode: repeated false range breaks. how_to_falsify: no edge after accounting for stop-outs and spread. suggested_null_or_control: breakout without volatility-percentile filter.

overfit_risk: low-medium. **priority:** high. **freshness_or_novelty:** common.
sources_supporting: intraday seasonal volatility and microstructure periodicity. ²⁹
sources_against_or_cautions: low vol can simply mean low interest and poor depth in alts. ³⁰

H13 — Range escape after realized-vol floor

hypothesis_id: H13; **short_name:** RV-floor range escape. **alpha_mechanism:** trade a directional break only after a statistically flat range and exceptionally low realized vol. **why_it_might_work:** similar to H12, but stricter; the edge comes from excluding noisy “pseudo-compressions.” ³¹
best_context_or_regime: 20–40 bar flat range, narrow candle dispersion.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: liquidity deterioration; exchange-specific anomaly.
universe: BTC, ETH, top-volume alt perps. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 1d–10d.
entry_rule_sketch: require flat range slope plus bottom-decile RV; enter on close outside range.
exit_rule_sketch: first failed close back inside range. **risk_stop_logic:** opposite range edge.
required_data: OHLCV. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public 1h/4h bars. **ideal_data:** mark, depth proxy, OI. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high.
Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.
main_failure_mode: stale regime with no directional follow-through. **how_to_falsify:** compare against generic Donchian breakout and show no incremental edge. **suggested_null_or_control:** Donchian breakout without RV-floor requirement. **overfit_risk:** low-medium. **priority:** high.
freshness_or_novelty: underused. **sources_supporting:** intraday periodicity and microstructure predictability work. ³¹ **sources_against_or_cautions:** execution risk rises if range is created by liquidity withdrawal. ³²

H14 — Breakout with rising OI, but only in liquid names

hypothesis_id: H14; **short_name:** OI-backed breakout. **alpha_mechanism:** continuation when price breaks out and OI rises, indicating new positioning rather than just short covering or thin liquidity.
why_it_might_work: OI contextualizes whether a move is attracting fresh leverage; practitioners and exchange education emphasize pairing OI with funding and price, not reading it alone. ³³
best_context_or_regime: high-liquidity names, spot-confirmed move.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: OI rises in illiquid token with unstable spread. **universe:** BTC, ETH, SOL, larger alts. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 4h–5d. **entry_rule_sketch:** breakout plus OI percentile rise and stable funding. **exit_rule_sketch:** OI and price diverge or close back into range. **risk_stop_logic:** breakout failure.
required_data: bars, OI, funding. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** Bybit/Binance public OI plus bars; Kraken needs forward capture for history. **ideal_data:** mark, liquidation stream. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.
live_capture_substitute_needed: yes on Kraken.
main_failure_mode: crowded one-way leverage blows off. **how_to_falsify:** no edge once liquid names are isolated and slippage is included. **suggested_null_or_control:** breakout without OI filter.
overfit_risk: medium. **priority:** medium-high. **freshness_or_novelty:** common.
sources_supporting: OI as contextual positioning measure. ³⁴ **sources_against_or_cautions:** OI can be misread; it says nothing by itself about side quality. ²⁸

H15 — Parabolic extension fade after momentum blow-off

hypothesis_id: H15; **short_name:** Blow-off fade. **alpha_mechanism:** short or reduce after a statistically abnormal vertical extension from moving averages or ATR. **why_it_might_work:** crypto

momentum exists, but momentum crashes and longer-horizon reversals are well documented; parabolic moves are especially unstable in speculative assets. ³⁵

best_context_or_regime: low-quality alt euphorias; extreme funding and social attention.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: post-breakout institutional demand in BTC/ETH.
universe: liquid-enough alts; occasional BTC/ETH blow-offs. **direction:** short. **holding_period:** hours–7d. **entry_rule_sketch:** short after climactic run with failed continuation bar or intraday reversal. **exit_rule_sketch:** cover into first panic flush or MA touch. **risk_stop_logic:** above final spike high.
required_data: OHLCV, funding. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars, funding.
ideal_data: OI, liquidation stream, borrowless perp crowding indicators. **data_tier:** Tier 1.
Kraken_feasibility: medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.
live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
main_failure_mode: squeeze against the fade. **how_to_falsify:** fade only works by luck on a handful of extreme samples. **suggested_null_or_control:** mean-reversion fade without parabolic filter. **overfit_risk:** high. **priority:** medium. **freshness_or_novelty:** common.
sources_supporting: crypto reversal and momentum-crash risks. ³⁵
sources_against_or_cautions: strong trend regimes can stay overbought far longer than a small account can survive. ³⁶

Funding, open-interest and liquidation hypotheses

H16 — Positive funding plus rising OI continuation

hypothesis_id: H16; **short_name:** Crowded-long continuation. **alpha_mechanism:** moderate positive funding with rising OI can confirm sustained bullish demand before extremes.
why_it_might_work: funding reflects net positioning, and a modest positive rate with orderly OI growth can be healthy rather than contrarian. ³⁷
best_context_or_regime: early/mid trend; spot leading perp.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: funding in top decile or close to venue caps. **universe:** BTC, ETH, major alts. **direction:** long. **holding_period:** 8h–5d. **entry_rule_sketch:** buy pullback in uptrend when funding positive but below extreme threshold and OI trending up.
exit_rule_sketch: exit when funding spikes or OI diverges. **risk_stop_logic:** below pullback low.
required_data: bars, funding, OI. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars, funding history, OI history where available. **ideal_data:** basis, liquidation flow. **data_tier:** Tier 1.
Kraken_feasibility: medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.
live_capture_substitute_needed: yes on Kraken for OI history.
main_failure_mode: late-stage leverage pile-on. **how_to_falsify:** no difference between modest and extreme funding bins once trend is controlled. **suggested_null_or_control:** uptrend pullback without funding/OI filter. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** medium. **freshness_or_novelty:** common. **sources_supporting:** funding/OI as joined context, not standalone. ³⁸
sources_against_or_cautions: interpretation fails when side concentration becomes fragile. ³⁹

H17 — Extreme positive funding fade

hypothesis_id: H17; **short_name:** Funding-extreme short. **alpha_mechanism:** short crowded longs when funding reaches extreme annualized carry and price stalls. **why_it_might_work:** extreme funding implies longs are paying an unusually high cost to maintain exposure; Kraken flags 0.10% per 8h as already more than 100% annualized. ⁴⁰

best_context_or_regime: extended run-up; loss of momentum near highs.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: strong spot demand from structural buyers. **universe:** BTC, ETH, liquid alts. **direction:** short. **holding_period:** hours-4d. **entry_rule_sketch:** short only after funding extreme and price fails to make new highs. **exit_rule_sketch:** cover on first sharp puke or funding normalization. **risk_stop_logic:** above failed-break high.
required_data: bars, funding. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars and funding history.
ideal_data: OI, basis, liquidation heatmap. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high.
Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.
main_failure_mode: steamrolling by true spot-led bull run. **how_to_falsify:** no edge after conditioning on trend maturity and momentum stall. **suggested_null_or_control:** short every funding extreme without price-stall filter. **overfit_risk:** medium-high. **priority:** high.
freshness_or_novelty: common. **sources_supporting:** funding as crowding cost. ⁴⁰
sources_against_or_cautions: high funding can persist in strong trends. ⁴¹

H18 — Extreme negative funding squeeze long

hypothesis_id: H18; **short_name:** Negative-funding squeeze. **alpha_mechanism:** buy after extreme negative funding when downside momentum stops extending. **why_it_might_work:** extreme short crowding can create reflexive squeezes, especially when spot sellers are exhausted and perps are paying to stay short. ⁴²
best_context_or_regime: panic selloffs into support; no new macro shock.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: genuine regime break with falling spot liquidity.
universe: BTC, ETH, majors, some large alts. **direction:** long. **holding_period:** hours-3d.
entry_rule_sketch: enter on negative-funding extreme plus failure to make fresh lows.
exit_rule_sketch: cover into squeeze or funding normalization. **risk_stop_logic:** below panic low.
required_data: bars, funding. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars and funding history.
ideal_data: OI drop, liquidation stream. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high.
Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** optional.
main_failure_mode: buying into real deleveraging continuation. **how_to_falsify:** no asymmetry between negative-funding and neutral-funding capitulations. **suggested_null_or_control:** buy any 3-sigma down day. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** high. **freshness_or_novelty:** common.
sources_supporting: funding data and post-crash negative-funding observations. ⁴²
sources_against_or_cautions: short-side crowding is not enough if liquidity is disappearing. ⁴³

H19 — Funding-window pin and pre-settlement mean reversion

hypothesis_id: H19; **short_name:** Funding-window pin. **alpha_mechanism:** mean reversion in the hours before settlement as traders reduce or re-shape positions around funding. **why_it_might_work:** academic work finds U-shaped activity and spreads over funding cycles, and exchange docs make clear that settlement timing is deterministic and venue-specific. ⁴⁴
best_context_or_regime: markets with elevated premium/discount but no fresh catalyst.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: strong spot impulse overwhelms settlement effects.
universe: BTC, ETH, top majors. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 1-6h.
entry_rule_sketch: fade stretched premium move into settlement window if price stalling.
exit_rule_sketch: exit just after settlement or on break of local extreme. **risk_stop_logic:** very tight session stop.

required_data: bars, funding interval schedule, mark. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars, mark, funding schedule. **ideal_data:** premium index and orderbook. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high in EEA and US, with parameter changes by interval. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no. **main_failure_mode:** trying to fade real information flow. **how_to_falsify:** no cycle-position effect after removing event hours. **suggested_null_or_control:** same mean-reversion rule at random hours. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** funding-cycle natural experiment; official settlement timings. ⁴⁴ **sources_against_or_cautions:** settlement-driven spreads can widen, hurting fills. ⁴⁵

H20 — Post-funding continuation when premium survives

hypothesis_id: H20; **short_name:** Premium survives settlement. **alpha_mechanism:** continuation if price premium remains after settlement, suggesting spot demand is stronger than funding friction. **why_it_might_work:** if funding fails to pull perp back toward spot, the move is often spot-led or structurally demanded rather than purely levered crowding. ⁴⁶ **best_context_or_regime:** trend days; institutional/ETF/spot-led flows. **worst_context_or_disable_condition:** thin alt without reliable index. **universe:** BTC, ETH, very liquid majors. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 2h-2d. **entry_rule_sketch:** buy or short after settlement if premium/discount persists and price re-accelerates. **exit_rule_sketch:** premium collapse or opposite impulse. **risk_stop_logic:** local post-settlement low/high. **required_data:** mark, premium/funding, bars. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public mark/bars plus funding. **ideal_data:** basis and spot lead measures. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** medium-high. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no. **main_failure_mode:** misunderstanding index lag or venue-specific mark behavior. **how_to_falsify:** no conditional edge versus generic trend-follow. **suggested_null_or_control:** trend entry without settlement filter. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** medium-high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** perpetual pricing and funding mechanics. ⁴⁷ **sources_against_or_cautions:** mark and funding formulas differ across venues. ⁴⁸

H21 — Deleveraging reclaim long

hypothesis_id: H21; **short_name:** OI-puke reclaim. **alpha_mechanism:** buy after a rapid drop in OI and sharp price flush, once price reclaims a key level. **why_it_might_work:** forced deleveraging clears weak hands; large liquidation episodes show abrupt OI collapses and then technical rebounds. ⁴⁹ **best_context_or_regime:** crash day or mini-cascade with fast OI destruction. **worst_context_or_disable_condition:** continuing macro shock; liquidity still withdrawing. **universe:** BTC, ETH, liquid alts. **direction:** long. **holding_period:** hours-5d. **entry_rule_sketch:** look for crash low, OI washout, then reclaim of prior session level. **exit_rule_sketch:** first lower high or retrace target. **risk_stop_logic:** below reclaim pivot. **required_data:** bars, OI, mark. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** Bybit/Binance OI plus bars; Kraken requires forward OI capture. **ideal_data:** liquidation stream and depth withdrawal. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** yes on Kraken. **main_failure_mode:** dead-cat bounce in a full regime shift. **how_to_falsify:** no advantage over simple oversold bounce after controlling for range size. **suggested_null_or_control:** buy any 5%

drop next bar. `overfit_risk`: medium. `priority`: high. `freshness_or_novelty`: underused. `sources_supporting`: liquidation events and OI collapses. ⁴⁹ `sources_against_or_cautions`: post-crash liquidity can stay hollow. ⁵⁰

H22 — OI-puke continuation short

`hypothesis_id`: H22; `short_name`: Cascade continuation short. `alpha_mechanism`: after the first liquidation wave, short a weak rebound if OI remains unstable and price cannot reclaim broken support. `why_it_might_work`: some cascades are not one-and-done; research and post-event reports show persistent depth depletion after major deleveraging. ⁵¹
`best_context_or_regime`: broad risk-off; hollow depth; failed reclaim.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition`: decisive reclaim with stabilizing funding. `universe`: majors and large alts. `direction`: short. `holding_period`: hours-3d. `entry_rule_sketch`: short weak bounce under broken VWAP/support after cascade. `exit_rule_sketch`: cover on OI stabilization or reclaim. `risk_stop_logic`: above failed-reclaim high.
`required_data`: bars, OI, funding. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data`: public bars and OI where available. `ideal_data`: liquidation stream and depth. `data_tier`: Tier 1. `Kraken_feasibility`: medium. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high.
`live_capture_substitute_needed`: yes on Kraken.
`main_failure_mode`: shorting the exact low after leverage reset. `how_to_falsify`: no edge when requiring failed reclaim and depth-hollow filters. `suggested_null_or_control`: short any rebound after a big down day. `overfit_risk`: high. `priority`: medium. `freshness_or_novelty`: underused. `sources_supporting`: persistence of hollow liquidity after crashes. ⁵¹
`sources_against_or_cautions`: deleveraging can create violent mean-reversion first. ⁵²

H23 — Mark-price dislocation reclaim

`hypothesis_id`: H23; `short_name`: Mark dislocation reclaim. `alpha_mechanism`: trade the snapback after a violent last-price wick that does not fully transmit to mark/index. `why_it_might_work`: major venues liquidate on mark, not last; mark-price dampers smooth fat-finger and stop-wick distortions, leaving transient last-price overshoots. ⁵³
`best_context_or_regime`: thin, sudden wick on otherwise stable broader market.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition`: true index move or news shock. `universe`: liquid majors and better alts. `direction`: both. `holding_period`: minutes-hours. `entry_rule_sketch`: fade an extreme wick when last diverges sharply from mark and mark is not broken. `exit_rule_sketch`: mean reversion to mark/VWAP. `risk_stop_logic`: if mark itself follows through.
`required_data`: trade/last, mark, index. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data`: public mark plus last-price bars; better with websocket. `ideal_data`: tick-by-tick trade stream. `data_tier`: Tier 2.
`Kraken_feasibility`: medium. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high.
`live_capture_substitute_needed`: yes.
`main_failure_mode`: assuming a wick is noise when it is actually price discovery. `how_to_falsify`: no edge once true-news bars are removed. `suggested_null_or_control`: fade any large one-bar move without mark filter. `overfit_risk`: medium-high. `priority`: medium. `freshness_or_novelty`: unusual. `sources_supporting`: official mark-price/liquidation design. ⁵³
`sources_against_or_cautions`: mark formulas differ by venue and can change. ⁵⁴

H24 — Liquidation-cluster breakout follow-through

`hypothesis_id`: H24; `short_name`: Liquidation cluster continuation. `alpha_mechanism`: join the

move after a visible liquidation burst if price holds the post-liquidation direction. `why_it_might_work`: liquidation prints can reveal forced directional flow; Bybit now provides full liquidation streams in real time.

`best_context_or_regime`: liquid majors and top alts during active sessions.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition`: one-off liquidation spike immediately reversed.
`universe`: Bybit/Binance-traded large perps. `direction`: both. `holding_period`: minutes-hours.
`entry_rule_sketch`: enter after cluster if post-cluster consolidation resolves same way.
`exit_rule_sketch`: exit on cluster reversal or time stop. `risk_stop_logic`: inside consolidation.
`required_data`: liquidation stream, bars. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data`: Bybit liquidation websocket and public bars. `ideal_data`: OI, orderbook imbalance. `data_tier`: Tier 2.
`Kraken_feasibility`: low. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high.
`live_capture_substitute_needed`: yes.
`main_failure_mode`: chasing terminal forced flow. `how_to_falsify`: no predictive value of liquidation clusters beyond contemporaneous bar range. `suggested_null_or_control`: breakout after any large volume cluster. `overfit_risk`: medium-high. `priority`: medium-high.
`freshness_or_novelty`: unusual. `sources_supporting`: full-stream liquidation availability and cascade research. ⁵⁵ `sources_against_or_cautions`: liquidation data can arrive with latency or be venue-specific. ⁵⁶

H25 — ADL and insurance-stress de-risk overlay

`hypothesis_id`: H25; `short_name`: ADL stress overlay. `alpha_mechanism`: reduce gross exposure when venue-level ADL risk or insurance-fund stress rises. `why_it_might_work`: ADL and insurance stress indicate impaired market absorbency and rising platform risk, not just price risk. Binance exposes symbol-level ADL risk; Bybit and Binance expose insurance-fund data. ⁵⁷
`best_context_or_regime`: high leverage regimes, macro risk days, alt perps with unstable depth.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition`: calm market, low ADL risk. `universe`: portfolio overlay across traded perps. `direction`: overlay. `holding_period`: event-driven. `entry_rule_sketch`: cut size or hedge when ADL risk rises or venue stress clusters. `exit_rule_sketch`: restore only after stress normalization. `risk_stop_logic`: not a price stop; it is a gross-exposure throttle.
`required_data`: official ADL/insurance indicators. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data`: Binance public ADL and insurance snapshots; Bybit insurance. `ideal_data`: venue breadth of liquidations and depth.
`data_tier`: Tier 1. `Kraken_feasibility`: low-medium.
`Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high. `live_capture_substitute_needed`: no.
`main_failure_mode`: being too conservative and giving up upside. `how_to_falsify`: no reduction in tail loss or liquidation risk during stress episodes. `suggested_null_or_control`: static leverage cap.
`overfit_risk`: low. `priority`: medium-high. `freshness_or_novelty`: underused.
`sources_supporting`: official ADL and insurance mechanisms. ⁵⁸
`sources_against_or_cautions`: venue signals are not standardized across exchanges. ⁵⁹

H26 — Cross-venue funding divergence trade

`hypothesis_id`: H26; `short_name`: Funding divergence mean reversion. `alpha_mechanism`: when one venue's funding is far above peers, expect convergence through price, funding, or both.
`why_it_might_work`: research on funding-rate market structure shows partial but incomplete integration, with meaningful arbitrage spreads present at times. ⁶⁰
`best_context_or_regime`: same coin across several major CEX venues.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition`: venue-specific listing, margin, or clientele shock.

universe: BTC, ETH, SOL, other widely listed perps. direction: overlay. holding_period: hours-days. entry_rule_sketch: express via relative under/overweight or spot/perp hedge on richest venue. exit_rule_sketch: divergence closes. risk_stop_logic: venue-risk stop, not just price stop. required_data: multi-venue funding and price. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public exchange funding endpoints and tickers. ideal_data: full basis curve and fee schedule. data_tier: Tier 1. Kraken_feasibility: medium as one leg. Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. live_capture_substitute_needed: no. main_failure_mode: divergence is justified by venue risk or customer segmentation. how_to_falsify: no convergence after controlling for fees and funding interval differences. suggested_null_or_control: random venue pair spread. overfit_risk: medium. priority: medium. freshness_or_novelty: underused. sources_supporting: cross-venue funding integration research. ⁶⁰ sources_against_or_cautions: official mechanics differ materially by venue. ⁶¹

H27 — Flat price, rising OI, delayed breakout

hypothesis_id: H27; short_name: Flat-price OI build. alpha_mechanism: compression with rising OI forecasts later range break. why_it_might_work: new positions are accumulating without resolution; once one side loses, price can move abruptly. ⁶²
 best_context_or_regime: liquid coins in 1-5 day boxes. worst_context_or_disable_condition: illiquid token where OI increase is exchange-local noise. universe: BTC, ETH, majors. direction: both. holding_period: 4h-4d. entry_rule_sketch: wait for rising OI inside tight range, then trade breakout in direction of RS or funding cue. exit_rule_sketch: if range re-enters. risk_stop_logic: opposite side of box.
 required_data: OI, bars, funding. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public OI/bars. ideal_data: liquidation stream, basis. data_tier: Tier 1. Kraken_feasibility: medium.
 Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. live_capture_substitute_needed: yes on Kraken.
 main_failure_mode: OI build resolves into fake breakout. how_to_falsify: no better than plain box breakout once coin and trend are controlled. suggested_null_or_control: box breakout without OI buildup filter. overfit_risk: medium. priority: medium-high. freshness_or_novelty: underused. sources_supporting: OI interpretation literature. ⁶²
 sources_against_or_cautions: OI is ambiguous without venue and funding context. ²⁸

H28 — Flat price, falling OI, spot-led persistence

hypothesis_id: H28; short_name: OI bleed trend persistence. alpha_mechanism: in an uptrend, price flat-to-up while OI bleeds can indicate healthier spot-led trend and less crowding.
 why_it_might_work: leverage wicks out while price holds, leaving a less fragile structure. ⁶³
 best_context_or_regime: major-coin grind higher after a squeeze.
 worst_context_or_disable_condition: OI bleeding because interest is dying broadly. universe: BTC, ETH, liquid majors. direction: long. holding_period: 1d-2w. entry_rule_sketch: buy pullback or breakout when OI trend is down but price trend intact. exit_rule_sketch: OI re-expands aggressively or price loses trend. risk_stop_logic: trend stop under structure.
 required_data: bars, OI. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public OI/bars. ideal_data: spot-vs-perp volume split. data_tier: Tier 1. Kraken_feasibility: medium.
 Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. live_capture_substitute_needed: yes on Kraken.

main_failure_mode: interpreting apathy as constructive deleveraging. **how_to_falsify:** no edge versus normal pullback buys. **suggested_null_or_control:** trend pullback without OI trend filter. **overfit_risk:** medium-high. **priority:** medium. **freshness_or_novelty:** unusual. **sources_supporting:** contextual OI/funding framework. ⁶³ **sources_against_or_cautions:** exchange docs and educational material warn that OI alone is commonly misread. ²⁸

H29 — Funding flip after trend break

hypothesis_id: H29; **short_name:** Funding-flip reversal. **alpha_mechanism:** a clean trend break becomes more credible when funding flips sign and stays there. **why_it_might_work:** funding sign change indicates that the carrying crowd has changed sides, not just that price blipped through a technical level. ⁶⁴

best_context_or_regime: mature trends near inflection points. **worst_context_or_disable_condition:** low-liquidity coins with noisy funding. **universe:** BTC, ETH, liquid alts. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 1d-10d. **entry_rule_sketch:** enter after structural break plus persistent funding flip for one or more intervals. **exit_rule_sketch:** funding flips back or price reclaims broken trend. **risk_stop_logic:** swing-based. **required_data:** price and funding. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public funding history plus bars. **ideal_data:** OI and spot/perp basis. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no. **main_failure_mode:** late confirmation after much of the move is gone. **how_to_falsify:** no improvement in downside/upside capture versus pure trend-break rule. **suggested_null_or_control:** price-break rule without funding flip. **overfit_risk:** low-medium. **priority:** medium. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** funding sign changes and carry logic. ⁶⁴ **sources_against_or_cautions:** funding is venue-specific and may lag the move. ⁶⁵

H30 — Venue-mark asymmetry filter

hypothesis_id: H30; **short_name:** Mark/last asymmetry filter. **alpha_mechanism:** avoid aggressive entries when a venue's last price is moving fast but mark lags meaningfully, or prefer venues with cleaner mark alignment. **why_it_might_work:** liquidation and PnL are mark-based on major venues, so the tradable risk is not the same as charted last price. ⁶⁶ **best_context_or_regime:** high-volatility small-cap perps. **worst_context_or_disable_condition:** deep liquid majors where mark/last spread is tiny. **universe:** all traded perps as execution filter. **direction:** overlay. **holding_period:** intraday. **entry_rule_sketch:** down-rank or skip trades when mark/last divergence exceeds threshold. **exit_rule_sketch:** normalize when divergence closes. **risk_stop_logic:** switch venue or shrink size. **required_data:** mark and last. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** official ticker/mark feeds. **ideal_data:** order book and index constituents. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no. **main_failure_mode:** overfiltering and missing genuine moves. **how_to_falsify:** no improvement in realized stop quality or liquidation avoidance. **suggested_null_or_control:** same strategy without mark/last filter. **overfit_risk:** low. **priority:** high as execution overlay. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** official mark/liquidation methodology. ⁶⁶ **sources_against_or_cautions:** venue formulas change, and some venues bound mark differently. ⁶⁷

Session, catalyst and cross-asset hypotheses

H31 — Asia-open momentum continuation

hypothesis_id: H31; **short_name:** Asia-open drift. **alpha_mechanism:** exploit continuation or fresh ORB behavior around Asian cash-session activation. **why_it_might_work:** intraday trend research finds strong seasonality linked to Asian market open; broader intraday studies show identifiable periodicities even in 24/7 crypto. ⁶⁸

best_context_or_regime: BTC/ETH trending or post-U.S. handoff.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: major U.S. macro event pending within hours. **universe:** BTC, ETH, majors. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 1-8h. **entry_rule_sketch:** trade breakout or continuation from pre-Asia range. **exit_rule_sketch:** close into Europe handoff or ORB failure.

risk_stop_logic: opening-range stop.

required_data: intraday OHLCV. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** 5m/15m public bars.

ideal_data: mark, session-labeled volume, venue spread. **data_tier:** Tier 1.

Kraken_feasibility: high. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.

live_capture_substitute_needed: no.

main_failure_mode: session effect swamped by dominant macro flow. **how_to_falsify:** no time-of-day edge after controlling for trend and volatility. **suggested_null_or_control:** same ORB at random clock times. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused.

sources_supporting: Asia-linked intraday seasonality. ⁶⁸ **sources_against_or_cautions:** seasonality is unstable and may decay once widely exploited. ⁶⁹

H32 — U.S. cash-open spillover

hypothesis_id: H32; **short_name:** NY open spillover. **alpha_mechanism:** trade BTC/ETH and selected perps around U.S. cash equity open and first hour. **why_it_might_work:** options and intraday studies show elevated crypto activity around NYSE hours and broader spillovers from traditional equity market timing. ⁷⁰

best_context_or_regime: macro-sensitive tape; ETF or equity-beta day.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: weekend; exchange outage. **universe:** BTC, ETH, COIN-beta proxies where available, major alts. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 30m-6h.

entry_rule_sketch: ORB or continuation in direction of pre-open move if first 15m confirms.

exit_rule_sketch: end of first hour or failed ORB. **risk_stop_logic:** opening-range stop.

required_data: intraday bars. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars. **ideal_data:** ETF flow nowcasts, futures basis. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high.

Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.

main_failure_mode: no spillover on purely crypto-native days. **how_to_falsify:** no excess expectancy in U.S. open window after controls. **suggested_null_or_control:** same ORB at Asia hours.

overfit_risk: medium. **priority:** high. **freshness_or_novelty:** common.

sources_supporting: time-of-day concentration near NYSE open. ⁷⁰

sources_against_or_cautions: weekend and non-U.S. hours still carry major information. ⁷¹

H33 — Scheduled FOMC breakout filter

hypothesis_id: H33; **short_name:** FOMC event breakout. **alpha_mechanism:** stand aside until FOMC release, then trade first clean post-release directional resolution rather than pre-positioning.

why_it_might_work: scheduled FOMC communication produces predictable spikes in intraday volatility in major cryptocurrencies. ⁷²

best_context_or_regime: BTC/ETH and top majors; high compression before event.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: already-trending market with no event uncertainty.
universe: BTC, ETH, liquid majors. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** minutes-2d.
entry_rule_sketch: wait for first post-release range; trade break only after initial whipsaw settles.
exit_rule_sketch: end of day or first reversal. **risk_stop_logic:** event-range stop; reduced size.
required_data: intraday bars and macro calendar. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars plus public FOMC schedule. **ideal_data:** mark, volume, options vol. **data_tier:** Tier 1.
Kraken_feasibility: high. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.
live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
main_failure_mode: getting chopped by the post-release second move. **how_to_falsify:** no edge over random high-volatility afternoons. **suggested_null_or_control:** same breakout rule on non-FOMC days matched by RV. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** medium-high.
freshness_or_novelty: common. **sources_supporting:** FOMC-specific crypto volatility research.
⁷² **sources_against_or_cautions:** macro-news effects are not always stable across cycles. ⁷³

H34 — CPI and NFP post-release trend day

hypothesis_id: H34; **short_name:** Macro release trend day. **alpha_mechanism:** major macro surprises create immediate volatility and sometimes session-long directional drift that can be traded only after confirmation. **why_it_might_work:** intraday studies find U.S. macro surprises and monetary-policy news materially affect seasonal volatility in BTC and ETH. ⁷⁴
best_context_or_regime: BTC, ETH on inflation/labor days.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: no macro surprise; preexisting conflicting crypto catalyst.
universe: BTC, ETH, large beta alts. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** hours-1d.
entry_rule_sketch: trade first pullback in release direction only if first 30m confirms.
exit_rule_sketch: end-of-session or loss of VWAP. **risk_stop_logic:** release-range stop.
required_data: bars and macro calendar. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars and official calendar. **ideal_data:** ETF/futures basis response. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** high. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.
main_failure_mode: fake impulse followed by full retrace. **how_to_falsify:** no effect of macro surprise days after filtering by realized surprise size. **suggested_null_or_control:** same first-pullback rule on random high-RV days. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** medium.
freshness_or_novelty: underused. **sources_supporting:** macro-news seasonal volatility effects.
⁷⁴ **sources_against_or_cautions:** event-sample counts are small for some releases. ⁷³

H35 — ETF flow day lead into overnight crypto drift

hypothesis_id: H35; **short_name:** ETF-flow spillover. **alpha_mechanism:** strong U.S. ETF-related or spot-led demand days create overnight drift in BTC and then in high-beta alts. **why_it_might_work:** ETF approval and post-approval studies show structural effects on returns and volatility; U.S. session activity has become more important in BTC price formation. ⁷⁵
best_context_or_regime: BTC structural bull phase; positive U.S. spot demand.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: ETF-news aftershock already fully priced intraday.
universe: BTC first, then ETH/high-beta alts. **direction:** long, sometimes short after extreme negative spot shock. **holding_period:** overnight to 2d. **entry_rule_sketch:** react to strong U.S.-cash-session BTC close and positive institutional-flow regime. **exit_rule_sketch:** Asia/Europe failure or next U.S. open. **risk_stop_logic:** prior U.S. session low.
required_data: BTC bars, ETF/event calendar. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars and

public ETF-related event dates. `ideal_data`: actual ETF daily flows and futures basis. `data_tier`: Tier 1. `Kraken_feasibility`: medium-high. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high. `live_capture_substitute_needed`: no. `main_failure_mode`: mistaking broad beta day for ETF-specific impulse. `how_to_falsify`: no overnight drift conditional on U.S. session strength after ETF era split. `suggested_null_or_control`: overnight carry after any strong U.S. session close. `overfit_risk`: medium-high. `priority`: medium. `freshness_or_novelty`: underused. `sources_supporting`: ETF-approval effects and U.S.-hour clustering. ⁷⁵ `sources_against_or_cautions`: direct daily ETF-flow datasets are not always frictionless to source. ⁷⁶

H36 — Weekend illiquidity breakout in alts

`hypothesis_id`: H36; `short_name`: Weekend alt breakout. `alpha_mechanism`: selective small/medium-cap breakouts on weekends can run further because liquidity is thinner and reflexivity is higher. `why_it_might_work`: weekend volume is lower even if volatility is not uniformly higher, and crypto-specific weekend momentum differences remain an open question. ⁷⁷ `best_context_or_regime`: strong market sentiment; narrative-rich alt sector. `worst_context_or_disable_condition`: no liquidity, exchange-specific gaps, or macro risk into Monday. `universe`: liquid-enough alt perps only. `direction`: both, mostly long. `holding_period`: weekend to Monday Asia. `entry_rule_sketch`: trade weekend breakout only in coins with healthy spread and volume. `exit_rule_sketch`: into Monday handoff or failure back into range. `risk_stop_logic`: tighter size-adjusted stop because of wider weekend slippage. `required_data`: bars, spread proxy. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data`: public bars; live spread capture is better. `ideal_data`: top-book and venue spread. `data_tier`: Tier 2. `Kraken_feasibility`: low-medium. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: medium-high. `live_capture_substitute_needed`: yes for best implementation. `main_failure_mode`: illiquidity trap and fake prints. `how_to_falsify`: no weekend-specific improvement after spread costs. `suggested_null_or_control`: same breakout on weekdays. `overfit_risk`: high. `priority`: low-medium. `freshness_or_novelty`: speculative. `sources_supporting`: weekend momentum discussion and lower-volume conditions. ⁷⁷ `sources_against_or_cautions`: weekend volatility is not consistently higher in BTC. ⁷⁸

H37 — Sunday-night to Monday mean reversion

`hypothesis_id`: H37; `short_name`: Sunday/Monday snapback. `alpha_mechanism`: fade late-weekend abnormal moves that are not confirmed by Monday institutional participation. `why_it_might_work`: if weekend flows are thinner, outsized weekend moves can partly retrace when full global liquidity returns. ⁷⁹ `best_context_or_regime`: large weekend move in alts without BTC confirmation. `worst_context_or_disable_condition`: genuine weekend catalyst with broad confirmation. `universe`: liquid alts, sometimes BTC/ETH. `direction`: both. `holding_period`: 4h–24h. `entry_rule_sketch`: fade late-Sunday extension into Monday Europe/U.S. if price stalls. `exit_rule_sketch`: cover by Monday U.S. open or after gap fill. `risk_stop_logic`: above weekend extreme. `required_data`: hourly bars. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data`: public bars. `ideal_data`: spread and OI change. `data_tier`: Tier 1. `Kraken_feasibility`: medium-high. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high. `live_capture_substitute_needed`: no. `main_failure_mode`: fading the start of a real Monday trend. `how_to_falsify`: no mean reversion

conditional on no-news weekends. `suggested_null_or_control`: fade any 48h move irrespective of weekday. `overfit_risk`: medium-high. `priority`: medium. `freshness_or_novelty`: underused. `sources_supporting`: weekend effect literature and volume patterns. ⁷⁹
`sources_against_or_cautions`: calendar anomalies in crypto are unstable across samples. ⁸⁰

H38 — Month-end and quarter-end de-risking

`hypothesis_id`: H38; `short_name`: Period-end de-risk. `alpha_mechanism`: trade cautious short bias or reduced size near month/quarter end when cross-asset risk management intensifies.
`why_it_might_work`: crypto increasingly transmits and receives shocks from broader financial markets, so period-end cross-asset risk reduction can spill over. ⁸¹
`best_context_or_regime`: macro-sensitive BTC/ETH; year-end or quarter-end.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition`: idiosyncratic crypto catalyst overwhelms cross-asset flows.
`universe`: BTC, ETH, majors. `direction`: overlay or short bias. `holding_period`: 1-3d.
`entry_rule_sketch`: reduce long exposure or short weak majors into period-end if trend is already soft.
`exit_rule_sketch`: after first business day or on strong reclaim. `risk_stop_logic`: macro overlay, not standalone stop.
`required_data`: bar series and calendar. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data`: public bars.
`ideal_data`: cross-asset futures and ETF flow proxies. `data_tier`: Tier 1. `Kraken_feasibility`: high. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high. `live_capture_substitute_needed`: no.
`main_failure_mode`: weak or nonexistent calendar effect. `how_to_falsify`: no statistically distinct period-end return distribution. `suggested_null_or_control`: same 3-day windows mid-month.
`overfit_risk`: high. `priority`: low-medium. `freshness_or_novelty`: speculative.
`sources_supporting`: increasing crypto-TradFi spillovers. ⁸¹ `sources_against_or_cautions`: crypto-specific calendar effects frequently fail to persist. ⁸²

H39 — Post-upgrade or protocol-event base continuation

`hypothesis_id`: H39; `short_name`: Post-catalyst base. `alpha_mechanism`: after a major positive protocol event, the best entry is often the first higher low / base breakout, not the headline candle.
`why_it_might_work`: crypto event-study evidence shows abnormal returns around major events, and PEAD-style underreaction logic from other markets translates to slow diffusion after complex catalysts. ⁸³
`best_context_or_regime`: real, legible catalyst with improving on-chain/business narrative.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition`: event fully anticipated or immediately sold. `universe`: catalyst-driven alts and majors. `direction`: long. `holding_period`: 2d-4w. `entry_rule_sketch`: wait for 2-10 day base after catalyst spike, then buy breakout. `exit_rule_sketch`: catalyst gap fill or higher-low failure. `risk_stop_logic`: below base low.
`required_data`: bars and official event dates. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data`: public bars and project/exchange announcements. `ideal_data`: funding/OI around event. `data_tier`: Tier 1.
`Kraken_feasibility`: medium. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility`: high.
`live_capture_substitute_needed`: no.
`main_failure_mode`: buying a news pop with no second leg. `how_to_falsify`: no improvement over buying headline day close. `suggested_null_or_control`: buy event-day close without base requirement. `overfit_risk`: medium-high. `priority`: high. `freshness_or_novelty`: underused.
`sources_supporting`: crypto event studies and underreaction logic. ⁸³
`sources_against_or_cautions`: event classification is subjective and sample sizes can be thin. ⁸⁴

H40 — Failed catalyst short

hypothesis_id: H40; **short_name:** Failed catalyst fade. **alpha_mechanism:** short when a seemingly bullish catalyst cannot hold its initial repricing. **why_it_might_work:** failure after good news often reveals that positioning was already full or that the news was low quality. Event-study research includes both positive and negative abnormal returns around crypto news. ⁸⁵

best_context_or_regime: weak breadth; high pre-event run-up; positive funding.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: deep structural catalyst with real new buyers. **universe:** catalyst-driven perps. **direction:** short. **holding_period:** hours-2w. **entry_rule_sketch:** short loss of event-day low or failed retest of catalyst high. **exit_rule_sketch:** cover on first exhaustion flush or support. **risk_stop_logic:** above failed-retest high.

required_data: bars, event dates. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars and announcements. **ideal_data:** funding/OI and social-attention nowcast. **data_tier:** Tier 1.

Kraken_feasibility: medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.

live_capture_substitute_needed: no.

main_failure_mode: shorting a constructive base. **how_to_falsify:** no asymmetry between failed-catalyst and random failed-break setups. **suggested_null_or_control:** short failed breakout without catalyst tag. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused.

sources_supporting: crypto event studies with mixed reactions. ⁸⁵

sources_against_or_cautions: event tagging and hindsight bias are serious risks. ⁸⁴

H41 — Episodic pivot translation to crypto

hypothesis_id: H41; **short_name:** Crypto episodic pivot. **alpha_mechanism:** a major repricing day caused by real information can seed a multi-day trend if the move is defended. **why_it_might_work:** this is a careful translation of the equity episodic-pivot concept to crypto, restricted to catalysts that materially change access, regulation, listings, partnerships, or protocol economics. ⁸⁶

best_context_or_regime: high-quality catalyst in liquid coin.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: meme news or unverifiable rumor. **universe:** majors and liquid alts with real catalysts. **direction:** both, mostly long. **holding_period:** 2d-3w.

entry_rule_sketch: enter on day-2 continuation or first tight consolidation above event low.

exit_rule_sketch: loss of event midpoint or first distribution day cluster. **risk_stop_logic:** event-day low or defined base stop.

required_data: bars, event log. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars and official announcements. **ideal_data:** OI/funding around catalyst. **data_tier:** Tier 1.

Kraken_feasibility: medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.

live_capture_substitute_needed: no.

main_failure_mode: using low-quality or already-priced “catalysts.” **how_to_falsify:** no excess return after restricting to objectively important announcements. **suggested_null_or_control:** same structure on non-event high-volume days. **overfit_risk:** medium-high. **priority:** medium-high.

freshness_or_novelty: unusual. **sources_supporting:** episodic-pivot practitioner logic plus crypto event studies. ⁸⁶

sources_against_or_cautions: anecdotal practitioner setups can overfit if catalyst quality is not tightly defined. ⁸⁷

H42 — Post-catalyst base breakout

hypothesis_id: H42; **short_name:** Catalyst-base breakout. **alpha_mechanism:** separate the information day from the tradable day; buy the first clean base after the catalyst candle.

why_it_might_work: event drift and trend-following logic both favor waiting for structure after the

initial price discovery burst. ⁸⁸

best_context_or_regime: strong catalyst paired with orderly 3–10 day rest.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: immediate gap fill or breadth collapse. **universe:** event-driven majors and alts. **direction:** long. **holding_period:** 2d–4w. **entry_rule_sketch:** buy break of post-event mini-base with rising RS. **exit_rule_sketch:** base failure or time stop.
risk_stop_logic: below base low.
required_data: bars plus event dates. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars and public announcements. **ideal_data:** OI/funding and sector breadth. **data_tier:** Tier 1.
Kraken_feasibility: medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.
live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
main_failure_mode: buying into distribution after attention fades. **how_to_falsify:** no advantage over event-day entries. **suggested_null_or_control:** event-day close entry. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** event studies and breakout-base logic. ⁸⁸ **sources_against_or_cautions:** event windows vary a lot across catalysts. ⁸⁴

H43 — BTC leads alt-beta within hours

hypothesis_id: H43; **short_name:** BTC-to-alt lead-lag. **alpha_mechanism:** use recent BTC return/impulse to predict alt-beta continuation over the next 1–4 hours. **why_it_might_work:** cross-cryptocurrency return predictability is now documented, and newer work still finds BTC-led spillovers into alts. ⁸⁹

best_context_or_regime: high-beta, liquid alt basket; BTC dominance stable or falling.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: idiosyncratic alt catalyst dominates. **universe:** liquid alt perps. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 15m–8h. **entry_rule_sketch:** if BTC impulse exceeds threshold, buy or short selected alt basket with filtered beta. **exit_rule_sketch:** after horizon or on BTC reversal. **risk_stop_logic:** BTC invalidation stop plus alt-specific stop.
required_data: BTC and alt bars. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public intraday OHLCV.
ideal_data: lead/lag regression with mark and taker flow. **data_tier:** Tier 1.
Kraken_feasibility: medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.
live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
main_failure_mode: correlations break under alt-specific news. **how_to_falsify:** no out-of-sample predictive slope after transaction costs. **suggested_null_or_control:** same alt trade using its own lagged return only. **overfit_risk:** medium. **priority:** high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** cross-crypto return predictability. ⁸⁹
sources_against_or_cautions: lead-lag strength is state-dependent and can vanish in stress. ⁹⁰

H44 — ETH leads DeFi and L2 basket

hypothesis_id: H44; **short_name:** ETH-to-DeFi lead-lag. **alpha_mechanism:** ETH moves lead DeFi/L2/performance-beta coins over short horizons. **why_it_might_work:** related instruments often show stronger microstructure lead-lag links, and cross-crypto predictability is stronger among fundamentally connected names. ⁹¹
best_context_or_regime: ETH-specific narrative or ETF attention; DeFi/L2 breadth expansion.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: BTC-led market stress. **universe:** ETH-linked sector baskets. **direction:** both. **holding_period:** 15m–1d. **entry_rule_sketch:** trade sector basket in direction of ETH impulse once sector breadth confirms. **exit_rule_sketch:** on ETH reversal or sector breadth failure. **risk_stop_logic:** ETH invalidation and basket stop.

required_data: ETH and sector bars. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public OHLCV.
 ideal_data: mark, OI, sector-breadth dashboard. data_tier: Tier 1. Kraken_feasibility: low-medium. Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high.
 live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
 main_failure_mode: false thematic mapping. how_to_falsify: no stronger lead-lag than random matched basket. suggested_null_or_control: random alt basket with same beta. overfit_risk: high. priority: medium. freshness_or_novelty: unusual. sources_supporting: microstructure lead-lag among related instruments and cross-crypto predictability. ⁹¹
 sources_against_or_cautions: theme membership and narrative labels are fluid. ⁹²

H45 — Sector ignition breadth thrust

hypothesis_id: H45; short_name: Theme breadth thrust. alpha_mechanism: buy the theme leader or basket when several associated perps break above short-term highs together.
 why_it_might_work: sector-level underreaction and cross-return spillovers make simultaneous breadth expansion more informative than a single-coin move. ⁹³
 best_context_or_regime: early narrative rotation with BTC calm.
 worst_context_or_disable_condition: late manic rotation. universe: AI, DeFi, L2, memecoin, gaming sector baskets. direction: long. holding_period: 1d-2w. entry_rule_sketch: require 3+ names in theme to trigger breadth signal; enter leader or equal-weight basket. exit_rule_sketch: breadth roll-over below threshold. risk_stop_logic: theme-level stop.
 required_data: bars across basket. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public OHLCV.
 ideal_data: OI/funding by sector, social interest. data_tier: Tier 1. Kraken_feasibility: low. Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
 main_failure_mode: thematic correlation is fake and transient. how_to_falsify: no overperformance versus single-name momentum. suggested_null_or_control: buy strongest single coin without breadth trigger. overfit_risk: high. priority: medium-high.
 freshness_or_novelty: underused. sources_supporting: industry information effect, cross-crypto predictability, and observed narrative rotations. ⁹³ sources_against_or_cautions: narrative research is less rigorous than the momentum/funding literature. ⁹²

H46 — Sector exhaustion fade

hypothesis_id: H46; short_name: Theme exhaustion fade. alpha_mechanism: short laggards or sector basket when theme breadth peaks but leaders stop advancing. why_it_might_work: the same breadth that confirms ignition can signal exhaustion once participation is broad but leadership stalls. ⁹⁴
 best_context_or_regime: late-stage alt rotation; euphoric breadth.
 worst_context_or_disable_condition: sector still has fresh catalyst. universe: alt-theme baskets. direction: short. holding_period: 1d-1w. entry_rule_sketch: short when breadth is high but leader makes lower high and laggards continue chasing. exit_rule_sketch: cover on breadth washout or support. risk_stop_logic: above failed lower high.
 required_data: sector bars. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public OHLCV. ideal_data: OI/funding by sector. data_tier: Tier 1. Kraken_feasibility: low.
 Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
 main_failure_mode: shorting healthy broadening rather than exhaustion. how_to_falsify: no difference between breadth-peak fades and generic laggard shorts. suggested_null_or_control: short weakest basket member without breadth condition. overfit_risk: high. priority: medium.
 freshness_or_novelty: unusual. sources_supporting: cross-asset industry effects and cross-

crypto spillovers. ⁹⁴ `sources_against_or_cautions:` direct academic evidence for crypto theme exhaustion is thin. ⁹²

Lifecycle, venue and portfolio overlay hypotheses

H47 — Perp-launch day pump fade

`hypothesis_id:` H47; `short_name:` Perp launch fade. `alpha_mechanism:` short newly launched perp contracts after the initial launch pump if price cannot hold the first impulse. `why_it_might_work:` exchange listings and cross-listings generate positive abnormal returns, but newly tradeable derivatives also open a clean shorting channel and can attract pump-and-dump-like activity in thin names. ⁹⁵
`best_context_or_regime:` small/mid-cap launch with oversized day-one spike.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition:` strong real catalyst plus sustained spot bid. `universe:` fresh alt perps on larger venues. `direction:` short. `holding_period:` hours-7d.
`entry_rule_sketch:` wait for launch spike, then short first failed high or first lower high.
`exit_rule_sketch:` cover into first washout or base. `risk_stop_logic:` above launch high.
`required_data:` bars and launch announcements. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data:` public price bars and official listing announcements. `ideal_data:` OI/funding from launch onward. `data_tier:` Tier 1. `Kraken_feasibility:` not suitable. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:` high.
`live_capture_substitute_needed:` no.
`main_failure_mode:` squeezing against tiny free float and thin books. `how_to_falsify:` no average fade after launch across enough events net of borrowless perp costs. `suggested_null_or_control:` short random large up day in same small caps. `overfit_risk:` medium-high. `priority:` high.
`freshness_or_novelty:` underused. `sources_supporting:` listing abnormal returns, new-perp launch frequency, pump-and-dump dynamics. ⁹⁵ `sources_against_or_cautions:` some launches trend for days if the listing truly expands access. ⁹⁶

H48 — Perp launch with spot scarcity continuation

`hypothesis_id:` H48; `short_name:` Launch continuation in scarce float. `alpha_mechanism:` in some low-float names, perp launch plus thin spot supply creates continuation rather than fade.
`why_it_might_work:` not all launch effects are mean-reverting; some exchanges add leverage to already reflexive supply conditions. ⁹⁷
`best_context_or_regime:` low float, strong narrative, broad exchange exposure.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition:` obvious overhang or unlock. `universe:` new alt perps with thin float. `direction:` long. `holding_period:` hours-5d. `entry_rule_sketch:` buy only after launch-day consolidation holds high in range. `exit_rule_sketch:` failure of first base or sharp funding spike. `risk_stop_logic:` under launch-day midpoint or base low.
`required_data:` bars, launch info. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data:` public bars and official launch announcements. `ideal_data:` OI/funding, float/unlock calendar. `data_tier:` Tier 1.
`Kraken_feasibility:` not suitable. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:` medium-high.
`live_capture_substitute_needed:` no.
`main_failure_mode:` mistaking manipulation for sustainable scarcity. `how_to_falsify:` post-launch continuation survives only in anecdotal outliers. `suggested_null_or_control:` buy any launch-day hold without scarcity filter. `overfit_risk:` high. `priority:` medium. `freshness_or_novelty:` speculative. `sources_supporting:` launch-cycle commentary and small-cap insider pump risks. ⁹⁷
`sources_against_or_cautions:` pump-and-dump evidence in crypto is strong and reversals are common. ⁹⁸

H49 — First red day after launch mania

hypothesis_id: H49; **short_name:** First-red-day short. **alpha_mechanism:** after a blow-off launch move, the first decisive red day can trigger multi-day unwind. **why_it_might_work:** classic post-mania supply release, especially where early longs are trapped and shorts can finally press. ⁹⁹

best_context_or_regime: parabolic launch with huge intraday range.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: orderly constructive base forms instead of distribution.

universe: new alt perps. **direction:** short. **holding_period:** 1-7d. **entry_rule_sketch:** short first daily close below prior day low after launch climax. **exit_rule_sketch:** cover at first base or 20-30% unwind. **risk_stop_logic:** above launch top or first-red-day high.

required_data: daily bars, launch date. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public daily bars and announcements. **ideal_data:** OI funding from launch. **data_tier:** Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** not suitable. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.

live_capture_substitute_needed: no.

main_failure_mode: first red day is only a pause in ongoing squeeze. **how_to_falsify:** no excess continuation after first-red-day signal vs any red day after large move. **suggested_null_or_control:** short any day-two weakness. **overfit_risk:** medium-high. **priority:** medium-high.

freshness_or_novelty: underused. **sources_supporting:** launch and pump-dump dynamics. ⁹⁹

sources_against_or_cautions: launch cohorts are small and heterogeneous. ¹⁰⁰

H50 — Delisting and forced-settlement drift

hypothesis_id: H50; **short_name:** Delisting drift. **alpha_mechanism:** trade the pre-settlement drift into known delisting or forced settlement, usually with short bias or flattening overlay.

why_it_might_work: exchanges publish deterministic delisting/auto-settlement schedules; users are advised to close before forced settlement. ¹⁰¹

best_context_or_regime: low-quality token, forced settlement announced with enough lead time.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: rebranding or migration produces supportive spot buying.

universe: delisted or migrating perps. **direction:** short or overlay. **holding_period:** announcement to settlement. **entry_rule_sketch:** short weak names after delisting announcement if liquidity still adequate. **exit_rule_sketch:** flatten ahead of final settlement window.

risk_stop_logic: time-based and venue-risk based.

required_data: official delisting notices and bars. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public announcements and public price data. **ideal_data:** OI and basis into settlement. **data_tier:** Tier 1.

Kraken_feasibility: medium if listed there; otherwise not suitable.

Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.

main_failure_mode: poor liquidity and settlement distortions make theoretical edge untradeable.

how_to_falsify: no predictive drift versus matched distressed tokens.

suggested_null_or_control: distressed-token short without delisting notice. **overfit_risk:** low-medium. **priority:** medium-high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** official delisting mechanics and forced settlement language. ¹⁰¹

sources_against_or_cautions: liquidity can vanish before you can monetize the signal. ¹⁰²

H51 — Rebranding and migration settlement distortion

hypothesis_id: H51; **short_name:** Rebrand migration distortion. **alpha_mechanism:** exploit dislocations around contract removal for token rebrands/migrations. **why_it_might_work:** delist/settlement notices for rebranding can force position closures and temporary price strangeness unrelated to fundamental value. ¹⁰³

best_context_or_regime: small/mid-cap with clear migration timetable.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: migration is universally seen as positive and spot demand dominates.
universe: tokens undergoing redenomination, symbol change, chain migration.
direction: both. **holding_period:** days around notice and settlement. **entry_rule_sketch:** fade distorted perp premium/discount versus available spot proxy.
exit_rule_sketch: close before final settlement. **risk_stop_logic:** venue event stop.
required_data: notices, perp and spot bars. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public announcements and public bars. **ideal_data:** multi-venue prices, basis, token-conversion details.
data_tier: Tier 1. **Kraken_feasibility:** low-medium.
Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.
main_failure_mode: operational complexity overwhelms edge. **how_to_falsify:** no reliable distortions across enough migration events. **suggested_null_or_control:** same token around ordinary announcements. **overfit_risk:** high. **priority:** low-medium. **freshness_or_novelty:** unusual. **sources_supporting:** recent rebrand-related delisting notices. ¹⁰³
sources_against_or_cautions: sample size is small and operational details vary a lot. ¹⁰⁴

H52 — Small-cap overshoot reversal

hypothesis_id: H52; **short_name:** Small-cap reversal. **alpha_mechanism:** buy extreme down-day overshoots in small/mid-cap perps only after reclaim confirmation. **why_it_might_work:** crypto shows longer-horizon reversal, and illiquid altcoins suffer deeper liquidity drawdowns than BTC, which can create overshoot conditions. ¹⁰⁵
best_context_or_regime: risk-on broader market; idiosyncratic dump without existential news.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: fraud/delist/news or liquidity death spiral. **universe:** tradable small/mid-cap perps with minimum depth filters. **direction:** long. **holding_period:** hours-5d. **entry_rule_sketch:** require 3-5 sigma down move, then reclaim of intraday support.
exit_rule_sketch: resistance/VWAP or failed reclaim. **risk_stop_logic:** low of capitulation bar.
required_data: OHLCV, spread proxy. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars; live spread capture preferred. **ideal_data:** orderbook, liquidation stream. **data_tier:** Tier 2.
Kraken_feasibility: low. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** medium-high.
live_capture_substitute_needed: yes.
main_failure_mode: trying to catch structurally broken tokens. **how_to_falsify:** no positive skew after excluding delisting/scam/news names. **suggested_null_or_control:** buy any extreme down move without reclaim. **overfit_risk:** high. **priority:** medium-high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** reversal evidence and alt liquidity-stress asymmetry. ¹⁰⁵
sources_against_or_cautions: small-token pump-and-dump behavior is pervasive. ⁹⁸

H53 — Low-float squeeze detector

hypothesis_id: H53; **short_name:** Low-float squeeze rider/avoidance. **alpha_mechanism:** either ride or avoid names where thin float, rising OI, and fragile depth can produce violent squeezes.
why_it_might_work: small-cap perps can become retail traps when thin floats meet perpetual leverage. ¹⁰⁶
best_context_or_regime: newly popular alt perps with hyper-thin depth.
worst_context_or_disable_condition: deep spot market or large-cap coin. **universe:** small-cap perps. **direction:** both or overlay. **holding_period:** minutes-days. **entry_rule_sketch:** mostly a risk filter; aggressive traders can buy post-reclaim squeeze setups. **exit_rule_sketch:** very fast scaling at 2-3 ATR expansions. **risk_stop_logic:** tiny size, hard limits, no averaging.

required_data: bars, OI, depth proxy. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public bars plus OI and live-spread capture. ideal_data: top-book and liquidation stream. data_tier: Tier 2.
 Kraken_feasibility: low. Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: medium-high.
 live_capture_substitute_needed: yes.
 main_failure_mode: untradeable slippage and exchange-specific wicks. how_to_falsify: post-cost expectancy is negative even when direction is “right.” suggested_null_or_control: same set-up in large-cap names. overfit_risk: high. priority: medium as risk framework, low as standalone alpha. freshness_or_novelty: unusual. sources_supporting: low-float perp squeeze commentary and alt liquidity drawdowns. ¹⁰⁶ sources_against_or_cautions: the same structure can simply be manipulation. ⁹⁸

H54 — Exchange-specific premium anchoring

hypothesis_id: H54; short_name: Venue premium bias. alpha_mechanism: some venues systematically run richer or cheaper because of user mix, margin rules, or risk controls; use that to adjust entries or express relative-value trades. why_it_might_work: funding integration is incomplete, and official docs show material differences in funding interval, price limits, mark formulas, and margin logic across venues. ¹⁰⁷
 best_context_or_regime: cross-listed majors. worst_context_or_disable_condition: one-off venue outage or event. universe: BTC, ETH, SOL, broad cross-listed perps. direction: overlay.
 holding_period: hours-weeks. entry_rule_sketch: adjust expected fair entry by venue bias; optionally trade relative premium decay. exit_rule_sketch: when premium normalizes.
 risk_stop_logic: venue-risk and transfer-risk control.
 required_data: multi-venue mark, price, funding. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: public exchange endpoints. ideal_data: full fee/margin/risk-limit model. data_tier: Tier 1.
 Kraken_feasibility: medium. Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: high.
 live_capture_substitute_needed: no.
 main_failure_mode: structural mispricing lasts much longer than expected. how_to_falsify: no stable venue fixed effect out of sample. suggested_null_or_control: pooled venue data with no venue dummy. overfit_risk: medium. priority: medium-high. freshness_or_novelty: underused. sources_supporting: funding market-structure research and official rule heterogeneity. ¹⁰⁷ sources_against_or_cautions: exchange policies can change quickly. ¹⁰⁸

H55 — Cross-venue leader-follower execution arb lite

hypothesis_id: H55; short_name: Venue leader-follower. alpha_mechanism: use the faster venue’s move to time entries on the slower venue in the same instrument. why_it_might_work: lead-lag relationships in market microstructure are strongest among related instruments and prices/liquidity states; crypto fragmentation makes venue timing relevant. ¹⁰⁹
 best_context_or_regime: liquid majors during high activity.
 worst_context_or_disable_condition: latency too poor or mark/last mismatch too large.
 universe: BTC, ETH and a few very liquid alt perps. direction: both. holding_period: seconds-minutes. entry_rule_sketch: use venue A impulse as trigger for venue B entry if B lags historically.
 exit_rule_sketch: convergence or after tiny fixed horizon. risk_stop_logic: ultra-tight loss cap and latency fail-safe.
 required_data: live multi-venue trade/mark feed. minimum_no_vendor_test_data: live public websockets. ideal_data: tick-level synchronized feeds and depth. data_tier: Tier 3.
 Kraken_feasibility: low-medium. Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility: medium-high.

`live_capture_substitute_needed:` yes.
`main_failure_mode:` latency rents go to faster players. `how_to_falsify:` no positive edge net of fees and delay. `suggested_null_or_control:` random venue trigger. `overfit_risk:` high.
`priority:` low-medium for small firms without colocation. `freshness_or_novelty:` unusual.
`sources_supporting:` lead-lag microstructure research. ¹⁰⁹ `sources_against_or_cautions:` requires operational sharpness, and capacity is tiny. ¹¹⁰

H56 — Spread and liquidity regime switch filter

`hypothesis_id:` H56; `short_name:` Liquidity-regime breakout filter. `alpha_mechanism:` enable breakout systems only when spread and depth are healthy; disable or reverse expectations when liquidity deteriorates. `why_it_might_work:` altcoins face much sharper depth drawdowns than BTC, and crypto market-quality research shows liquidity conditions meaningfully affect short-horizon dynamics. ¹¹¹
`best_context_or_regime:` normal or improving depth. `worst_context_or_disable_condition:` sharp depth withdrawal, wide spreads, exchange incidents. `universe:` all traded perps. `direction:` overlay. `holding_period:` continuous filter. `entry_rule_sketch:` require spread/depth proxy below threshold before allowing entries. `exit_rule_sketch:` shrink or close when liquidity regime degrades.
`risk_stop_logic:` not price-based; regime-based de-risking.
`required_data:` spread proxy, perhaps book ticker. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data:` public best-bid/ask or bar-based effective spread estimate; Kraken/Bybit/Binance public feeds suffice. `ideal_data:` full top-book and depth history. `data_tier:` Tier 2. `Kraken_feasibility:` high for live use, medium for historical unless captured. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:` high.
`live_capture_substitute_needed:` yes for historical depth filter.
`main_failure_mode:` filter overreacts and blocks profitable volatility expansions. `how_to_falsify:` no improvement in post-cost expectancy or drawdown. `suggested_null_or_control:` same signal without liquidity filter. `overfit_risk:` low-medium. `priority:` high. `freshness_or_novelty:` underused. `sources_supporting:` alt liquidity stress and microstructure predictive power. ¹¹¹
`sources_against_or_cautions:` historical spread proxies from bars can be noisy. ¹¹⁰

H57 — Exchange outage or resume dislocation

`hypothesis_id:` H57; `short_name:` Outage/resume snapback. `alpha_mechanism:` trade dislocations caused by exchange service interruption, trading pause, or venue-specific restrictions once service resumes. `why_it_might_work:` service interruptions are exogenous shocks; exchange-paused markets can re-open at prices misaligned with the broader venue set. ¹¹²
`best_context_or_regime:` one venue disrupted while others keep trading.
`worst_context_or_disable_condition:` system-wide market outage or major news during outage.
`universe:` any cross-listed major or alt. `direction:` both. `holding_period:` minutes-hours.
`entry_rule_sketch:` compare disrupted venue price to live reference basket on resume; fade large unjustified gaps. `exit_rule_sketch:` convergence or if gap persists due to new information.
`risk_stop_logic:` hard cap due to operational uncertainty.
`required_data:` multi-venue live feeds and status pages. `minimum_no_vendor_test_data:` public status pages and live public prices. `ideal_data:` synchronized tick feeds and orderbook. `data_tier:` Tier 2. `Kraken_feasibility:` medium. `Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:` medium-high. `live_capture_substitute_needed:` yes.
`main_failure_mode:` resume gap reflects real info that accumulated during outage.
`how_to_falsify:` no systematic convergence after outages. `suggested_null_or_control:` fade normal opening gaps with no outage. `overfit_risk:` high due to rarity. `priority:` low.

freshness_or_novelty: unusual. **sources_supporting:** exchange interruption research and official status/rules. ¹¹² **sources_against_or_cautions:** outages are rare and operationally messy.

¹¹³

H58 — Alt-venue launch spillover to Kraken proxy

hypothesis_id: H58; **short_name:** Non-Kraken spillover proxy. **alpha_mechanism:** when a theme ignites on broader alt venues but the exact coin is unavailable on Kraken, trade the closest liquid proxy on Kraken. **why_it_might_work:** cross-crypto predictability and sector spillovers can transmit from unavailable leaders to correlated listed proxies. ¹¹⁴

best_context_or_regime: sector rotation with clear proxy hierarchy.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: weak mapping between unavailable leader and available proxy. **universe:** Kraken-listed majors and liquid proxies. **direction:** both, mostly long.

holding_period: hours-days. **entry_rule_sketch:** detect alt-venue sector leader move, then trade Kraken-listed proxy if it breaks relative structure. **exit_rule_sketch:** proxy underperforms or sector breadth fades. **risk_stop_logic:** proxy-specific stop.

required_data: broader-venue bars and Kraken bars. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public bars from both venues. **ideal_data:** sector basket breadth and OI. **data_tier:** Tier 1.

Kraken_feasibility: medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high as source signal. **live_capture_substitute_needed:** no.

main_failure_mode: proxy correlation fails exactly when needed. **how_to_falsify:** proxy response adds no incremental edge versus trading Kraken asset alone. **suggested_null_or_control:** Kraken breakout without external spillover signal. **overfit_risk:** high. **priority:** medium.

freshness_or_novelty: unusual. **sources_supporting:** cross-crypto spillovers. ¹¹⁴

sources_against_or_cautions: relationship may be loose and unstable. ²⁵

H59 — Funding and OI stress beta throttle

hypothesis_id: H59; **short_name:** Crowding throttle overlay. **alpha_mechanism:** alter gross and net exposure based on portfolio-weighted funding and OI stress. **why_it_might_work:** when many positions are long high-funding names simultaneously, the book is fragile to a single deleveraging shock.

¹¹⁵

best_context_or_regime: diversified perp book with several correlated longs or shorts.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: calm, low-crowding environment. **universe:** portfolio overlay. **direction:** overlay. **holding_period:** continuous. **entry_rule_sketch:** reduce book beta when weighted funding percentile and OI crowding exceed threshold. **exit_rule_sketch:** restore when crowding normalizes. **risk_stop_logic:** exposure cap, not price stop.

required_data: funding, OI, correlations. **minimum_no_vendor_test_data:** public funding/OI and portfolio prices. **ideal_data:** cross-venue crowding and liquidation stream. **data_tier:** Tier 1.

Kraken_feasibility: medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.

live_capture_substitute_needed: yes on Kraken for full OI history.

main_failure_mode: undertrading the best part of trends. **how_to_falsify:** no improvement in drawdown or liquidation avoidance. **suggested_null_or_control:** static gross limit. **overfit_risk:** low. **priority:** high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** funding/OI context and liquidation tail events. ¹¹⁵ **sources_against_or_cautions:** crowding metrics differ materially across venues and intervals. ¹¹⁶

H60 — Liquidation-aware trailing-stop overlay

hypothesis_id: H60; **short_name:** Liquidation-aware exit overlay. **alpha_mechanism:** adjust trailing stops and take-profit logic based on current risk of forced deleveraging rather than on price structure alone. **why_it_might_work:** liquidation risk depends on mark-price mechanics, maintenance rules, ADL, and venue stress; exits that ignore this can be technically “right” but operationally wrong. ¹¹⁷

best_context_or_regime: levered directional trading, especially in alts.

worst_context_or_disable_condition: spot-only or very low leverage. **universe:** portfolio overlay for all perp positions. **direction:** overlay. **holding_period:** continuous.

entry_rule_sketch: not an entry signal; use venue liquidation distance, mark/last divergence, ADL stress, and spread regime to tighten or loosen exit rules. **exit_rule_sketch:** dynamic trailing exits triggered sooner in stressed conditions. **risk_stop_logic:** primary purpose is to avoid mark-price liquidation and bad forced fills.

required_data: mark, margin rules, ADL/insurance indicators, spread proxy.

minimum_no_vendor_test_data: official rule docs, mark feeds, public ADL/insurance where available.

ideal_data: account-level liquidation estimates and live depth. **data_tier:** Tier 2.

Kraken_feasibility: medium. **Bybit_or_broader_alt_venue_feasibility:** high.

live_capture_substitute_needed: yes for best implementation.

main_failure_mode: too reactive, causing premature exits. **how_to_falsify:** no reduction in liquidation-adjacent losses or execution slippage during volatile periods. **suggested_null_or_control:** static ATR trailing stop. **overfit_risk:** low-medium. **priority:** high. **freshness_or_novelty:** underused. **sources_supporting:** official liquidation and ADL mechanics. ¹¹⁷

sources_against_or_cautions: formula changes and venue heterogeneity are real. ⁵⁴

Top 15 hypotheses to test first under no-vendor constraints

The ranking below puts the most weight on six things: plausibility, testability with public data, fit for small aggressive accounts, feasibility without paid vendors, regime specificity, and likely edge magnitude after fees and slippage. I favor hypotheses that can be tested with bars, mark, funding, OI, and public announcements today, and I demote ideas that mainly need tick/depth replay or very rare event samples. The top of the list is therefore not “most glamorous”; it is “most likely to survive first contact with public data and small-account execution.” ¹¹⁸

Rank	Hypothesis	Why it ranks here
1	H02 — Vol-managed TSMOM	Strongest evidence base, simple public-data test path, naturally capacity-light, and easy to disable during crash regimes. Supported by crypto TSMOM and volatility-managed momentum research. ⁶
2	H05 — Post-breakout retest	Excellent small-account fit because it reduces chasing and slippage; can be built from plain bars and mark. It also ports cleanly across venues and is easy to falsify. ¹³
3	H13 — RV-floor range escape	Very testable with public 1h/4h bars, highly regime-specific, and often cleaner than generic Donchian rules. ³¹

Rank	Hypothesis	Why it ranks here
4	H21 — Deleveraging reclaim long	High potential edge magnitude after real OI pukes; public OI on Bybit/Binance makes falsification possible even if Kraken needs forward capture. ⁴⁹
5	H19 — Funding-window pin	Precise clock-based structure, strong no-vendor path, and good fit for a small book that can turn risk on and off around fixed settlement times. ⁴⁴
6	H31 — Asia-open drift	Strong session evidence, easy clock-based backtest, and low data burden. Best implemented on BTC/ETH first. ⁶⁸
7	H32 — NY open spillover	Similar to H31 but more tied to current institutional/ETF-era BTC behavior and U.S. activity clustering. ⁷⁰
8	H42 — Post-catalyst base breakout	Better than raw headline chasing; uses public announcements plus bars and fits crypto's tendency toward second-leg moves after information digestion. ⁸⁸
9	H43 — BTC-to-alt lead-lag	Strong academic support and clear data path using public intraday bars. Naturally suited to small, tactical books. ⁸⁹
10	H17 — Extreme positive funding fade	Public and simple; very likely to show something real if thresholds are anchored to venue-specific funding mechanics. Needs discipline because strong trends can steamroll the fade. ⁴⁰
11	H18 — Extreme negative funding squeeze	Same virtues as H17, with particularly attractive upside when panic is clearly leverage-driven rather than fundamentally driven. ⁴²
12	H56 — Liquidity-regime breakout filter	Not a sexy signal, but one of the best ways to make all other public-data signals more robust in small accounts where slippage dominates. ¹¹¹
13	H47 — Perp-launch day pump fade	Event-driven, high edge magnitude if implemented with strict liquidity and risk rules; public announcement and bar data are enough for a first pass. Better on broader venues than Kraken. ⁹⁵
14	H52 — Small-cap overshoot reversal	High upside for a small, aggressive firm, but only after harsh execution filters. Public bars are enough to start; live spread capture should come quickly. ¹⁰⁵
15	H59 — Funding and OI stress beta throttle	Best portfolio-level risk overlay under no-vendor constraints. It will not create alpha alone, but it can preserve fragile alpha elsewhere. ¹¹⁵

A practical first-wave test stack would therefore look like this: one medium-horizon engine built around H02, one structural breakout engine built around H05 and H13, one clock-based intraday sleeve built around H19, H31, and H32, one leverage-stress sleeve built around H17, H18, and H21, one event sleeve built around H42 and H47, and one portfolio overlay layer built around H56 and H59. If these fail, the next

message is clear: the problem is not “lack of imagination,” but slippage, liquidity decay, and regime instability meeting public-data limits head-on. 119

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